

**HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION
SAMPLE PAPER
SESSION-2026-27**



**CLASS-IX
TIME-3 HRS**

**SUBJECT-ENGLISH
M.MARKS-80**

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

1. *The paper is divided into three sections:*
Section A: Reading (20Marks)
Section B: Grammar & Writing (25 Marks)
Section C: Literature (35 Marks)
2. *All questions are compulsory.*
3. *Separate instructions are given with each section and question, wherever necessary. Read these instructions very carefully and follow them.*
4. *Do not exceed the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.*

SECTION A: READING SKILLS (20 Marks)

Q1. Read the passage given below.

1. Experts say that what customers buy in the name of herbal cosmetics is often the same synthetic cosmetic with a herb or two added, which works to lure customers. A product that says it is 100% natural may be misleading in the sense that it's difficult to stabilize a fully natural base and is always quite expensive, requiring advanced technology. The desired shelf life of a product is expected to be at least two years, but that of a purely herbal product would be restricted to about six months. Also, the product won't be aesthetically appealing as a synthetic product. Hence manufacturers of herbal products have to include synthetic base ingredients to balance the formula.
2. Herbal ingredients might also cause allergies as they may contain a large number of constituents which may be allergic to that user. Thus the concept of using 'total extracts' may be harmful, because there are several other ingredients going into the product. Also, things like pH need to be considered before using it.
3. According to the law experts, customers suing someone is considered extreme. Given the legal system in India and the long-drawn litigation process, consumers tend to pursue legal action against manufacturers/distributors in the event of any problem. However, with the dawn of consumer forums and more effective laws protecting the interests of the consumers, the trend is slowly moving towards this direction.
4. At times it is not just manipulative manufacturers and passive consumers but sometimes weak and absent rules regarding the process of manufacturing can also get fake production licences. Also one cannot make a generalisation that synthetics are safe while naturals are harmful. I would say that the difference is that if one is a known devil (synthetics) the other is unknown. Unlike the case of synthetic cosmetic, herbal cosmetics are still in a nascent stage. You don't have well-defined standards for the use of raw materials in the production of herbal cosmetics.
5. Finally, customers can also check out their cosmetics by using the 'Cosmetics ingredient dictionary', a database of 19,000 ingredients. It claims to help users check out what chemical compounds they use daily. This App lets you feed the names of the ingredients written on the container into the app and then get the reading about it.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below. (1x10=10 Marks)

i. Why is it misleading when a product is labelled as 100% natural?

- a) It is misleading because it is difficult to stabilise a fully herbal base for the cosmetic.
- b) because natural cosmetics are expensive and require advanced technology.

- c) Both (a) and (b) are correct
- d) Only (b) is correct.

ii. Mention two drawbacks of natural products.

- a) have much shorter shelf life.
- b) not as appealing as synthetic products.
- c) as appealing as synthetic products.
- d) have no expiry date.

Choose the correct option.

- i) only a (ii) both (b) and (c) (iii) both (a) and (b) (iv) both (c) and (d)

iii. Why is taking recourse to legal action gaining momentum?

- a) because of the emergence of consumer forums
- b) because of more effective laws to protect the interest of consumers.
- c) only (a) is correct.
- d) both (a) and (b) are correct

iv. What is the cosmetics ingredient dictionary?

- a) an App device
- b) a data base of 19,000 names of ingredients.
- c) helps to check out chemical compounds use daily.
- d) All of the above.

v. As per the passage, customers in India don't easily sue someone because:

- a) legal systems are pathetic
- b) legal systems are long-drawn
- c) clients lose the time and money
- d) all of the above

vi. What is the desired shelf life of a purely herbal product?

vii. What is Cosmetics Ingredients Dictionary?

viii. The word from the passage that mean the same as 'skilful at influencing in an unfair Way is _____ (para 4)

ix. Why it is harmful to use 'Total Extract'?

x. What may cause allergies in some users?

Q2. Read the passage given below.

1. Many a time people feel fatigue because of poorly designed workspaces. Your desk, your chair, your computer and keyboard the placement, height, and angle of each of them – play a crucial role in preventing muscle and eye strain. That is what has given rise to an interest in the study of ergonomics. It is the applied science of equipment design at the workplace. Ergonomics is intended to reduce fatigue and discomfort for people sitting and working in offices.
2. So why does it make sense for organizations to follow ergonomic principles? In a recent study, it has been found that over 60% of individuals diagnosed with Repetitive Strain Injury (RSI) had received no training in strain injury at their offices and another 30% had received incorrect ergonomic advice.
3. Another interesting find has been that employees who turn up to work in spite of being in pain can cause massive productivity losses amounting to thousands of dollars annually. Research findings have shown that most offices in India are operating with furniture that is a mismatch to the highly networked work culture that exists and there is hardly any awareness among employees about ergonomics and how it impacts them. This has resulted in an alarming 71% of employees suffering from rapidly spreading Muscular Skeletal Disorders (MSD). The symptoms are back pain, shoulder pain of varying intensity, leading to lowering of productivity of employees at work.
4. To counter this problem, some companies have created volunteers who are part of a 'train and

trainers' initiative. They act as custodians of their bays and monitor their colleagues' postures and advise them on a day-to-day basis.

5. Talking about the part that employees can do to make their workplaces comfortable, some experts say that from an employee's perspective having knowledge of what is a safe working position, and what are the right ways of relieving fatigue, how the current set-up can be optimized, what simple solutions can be incorporated, can go a long way in creating a stress free environment with healthy employees.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below. (1x10=10 Marks)

i. The study of ergonomics is essential in workplaces because it:

- (a) plays a crucial role in preventing muscle and eye strain.
- (b) is intended to increase fatigue.
- (c) causes massive productivity gains.
- (d) cannot create a stress-free environment.

ii. To create a stress-free environment with healthy employees, organisations:

- (a) need to follow ergonomic principles.
- (b) must train the employees the science of ergonomics.
- (c) should engage specialist to detect the MSD (Muscular Skeletal Disorders).
- (d) are intended to look into the poorly designed workspaces.

iii. State True or False.

Ergonomics is the applied science of equipment design at the workplace.

iv. The symptoms of MSD (Muscular Skeletal Disorders) are back pain.

- a) shoulder (b) muscular (c) spine (d) cervical

v. To counter the problem of ergonomics, some organisations have created

.....who are part of a 'train and trainers' initiative.

- a) Teams (b) colleagues (c) volunteers (d) none of these

vi. Your desk, your chair, your computer and keyboard are the indispensable components of

vii. What do you mean by 'Trains and Trainers'?

viii. How do Ergonomics help people at their workplace?

viii. What are the different symptoms of Muscular Skeletal Disorders?

ix. What science deals with equipment design at the workplace?

x. What disorder is abbreviated as MSD?

SECTION B: GRAMMAR & WRITING (Grammar-10/Writing-15)

Q3. Attempt ANY TEN of the following questions. (1x10=10 Marks)

i. Fill the gap by choosing the most appropriate options from the given below.

There isn't _____ milk left in the refrigerator. (many / much / few / several)

ii. Read the dialogue and complete the passage given below.

Interviewer: So, why do you want to be a computer programmer?

Ravi: Well, I have always been interested in computers.

Ravi recently attended an interview for the selection of a computer programmer. At the interview, he was asked..... To this question he replied that he wanted to change his job because he had always been interested in computers.

iii. Read the conversation between Grandma and granddaughter and complete the statements by using appropriate modals.

G. Daughter: Neither of my friends _____ coming to the party. (is / has/ have/ are)

Grandma: That's unfortunate. You should invite someone else.

iv. Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given line.

If Suzan said that, it true. She never lies. (is / are/has/have)

v. Identify the error and supply correction: Cybrids are human-animal embryos create by using an empty or de-nucleated cow or rabbit cell.

Use the given format for your response.

ERROR	CORRECTION

vi. Fill in the blank by using the correct option given below.

There is water in the pond.

- a) little (b) few (c) least (d) a little

vii. Choose the best option to fill the gap below.

He is experienced than his brother.

- a) less (b) few (c) fewer (d) none

viii. Select the correct option to fill in the blank to complete the sentence.

..... you mind posting this letter for me?

- a) Does (b) Do (c) Have (d) Has

ix. Identify the error and supply correction: The postman deliver the post by 11 a.m. every day.

Use the given format for your response.

ERROR	CORRECTION

x. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs given in the brackets.

While the doctor (examine) the patient, there was an uproar in the hall.

xi. Choose the best option to fill the gap below.

Santa Claus, along with his helpers,able to give away all those toys. (is/are/have/were)

xii. Read the dialogue and complete the line given below.

Manu: Where are you going to?

Annu: I am going to the market. Do you want anything?

Manu asked Annu Annu replied that she was going to the market and she further asked if/whether she wanted anything.

Q4. Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below in 100-120 words.

A. Write a letter to the Editor of a national daily expressing concern over the increasing noise pollution in your city. Suggest suitable measures to control it.

OR

(5 marks)

B. Write a letter to the Editor of a newspaper highlighting the increasing number of road accidents in your city. Suggest measures to improve road safety.

Q5. Attempt ANY ONE from A & B given below. (100-120 words).

A. You are Rohan/Riya, a student of Class IX. You are concerned about the increasing problem of plastic pollution in your city. Write an article in 120-150 words for your school magazine on "Say No to Plastic". Discuss the causes and harmful effects of plastic pollution and suggest measures to reduce its use.

OR

(5 Marks)

B. Write an article on "The Importance of Sports in a Student's Life". Discuss how sports contribute to physical fitness, mental well-being, discipline and teamwork.

Q6. Attempt ANY ONE from A & B given below. (Word limit: 50 words)

@believe_tutorials

A. You are the Cultural Secretary of your school. Your school is organising an Inter-House Competition on the topic "Artificial Intelligence: A Boon or a Bane". Draft a **notice** informing s of Classes IX and X about the competition. Mention the date, time, venue and other details.

OR

(5 Marks)

B. You are the Head Boy/Girl of your school. Your school is organising a Cleanliness Drive on the school campus. Write a **notice** informing students about it. Mention the date, time, meeting place and things students should bring.

SECTION C: LITERATURE (35 Marks)

Q7. Attempt **ANY ONE** of two extracts given.

(5 Marks)

A. "The word *pankha* is believed to have originated from *pankh*, meaning a bird's feather. In ancient India, hand fans were used in temples to fan deities and in royal courts to provide comfort to kings."

i. The word '*pankha*' is believed to have originated from:

(1)

- | | |
|----------|----------|
| a) Patta | c) Pawan |
| b) Pankh | d) Pani |

ii. Where were hand fans used in ancient India?

(1)

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------|
| a) In temples and royal courts | c) In gardens and parks |
| b) In schools and markets | d) In homes and offices |

iii. Find a word from the passage that means 'gods or divine beings'.

(1)

iv. Why were hand fans used in royal courts?

(2)

OR

B. "I had a quiet morning, but I do t know about Ravi. He just disappeared instead of staying at home to look after me like you told him to."

i. Why was Ravi expected to stay at home?

(1)

- | | |
|------------------------------|-----------------|
| a) To study | c) To cook food |
| b) To look after the speaker | d) To play |

ii. What did Ravi do instead of staying at home?

(1)

- | | |
|---------------------------|----------------------|
| a) He went to school. | c) He disappeared. |
| b) He helped the speaker. | d) He went shopping. |

iii. Who was expected to look after the speaker?

(1)

iv. What did Ravi do instead of staying home?

(2)

Q8. Attempt **ANY ONE** of two extracts given.

(5 Marks)

A. I feel that the stillness of
my mother's gaze on my face
has spread all over the sky.

i. What does the speaker feel has spread all over the sky?

(1)

- | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| a) Her mother's voice | c) Her mother's smile |
| b) Her mother's gaze | d) Her mother's tears |

ii. What does the word "stillness" suggest in the lines?

(1)

- | | |
|-------------------------|--------------|
| a) Movement | c) Happiness |
| b) Silence and calmness | d) Anger |

iii. What does the mother's gaze represent in these lines?

(1)

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| a) Her mother's presence and memory | c) Her mother's journey |
| b) Her mother's anger | d) Her mother's excitement |

iv. Who is the speaker remembering in these lines?

(2)

OR

B. Read the extract given below and select the best answer out of the given options.

*The mighty Himavant is ours-there's no equal anywhere on earth.
The generous Ganga is ours-
which other river can match her grace?
The sacred Upanishads are ours-what scriptures else to name with them?*



- i. What does the poet suggest about the Himavant? (1)
 a) It is the highest mountain in the world
 b) It has no equal anywhere on earth
 c) It is covered with snow throughout the year
 d) It is difficult to climb
- ii. _____ river is described as “generous”. (1)
- iii. What does the poet praise as sacred?
 a) The Vedas
 b) The Upanishads
 c) The Puranas
 d) The Ramayana
- iv. Why does the poet consider the Ganga special? (2)

- Q9. Answer ANY FIVE questions in 40-50 words each, respectively. (5x3=15 marks)
 a) Why did the grandmother want to learn to read Kashi Yatre herself?
 b) Why does the poem emphasise the importance of respecting different vocations?
 c) What does “Vitamin-M” symbolise in the chapter?
 d) Write any two differences between the Rajasthani and Gujarati Pankha.
 e) How does the poet describe the greatness and beauty of Bharat?
 f) How does the poet compare the work of a gardener with that of an artist?

- Q10. Answer ANY ONE question in 100-120 words (5x1=5 Marks)
 a) How does the poem, 'Canvas of Soil' like the poem, 'Gifts of Grace: Honouring Our Vocations', celebrates and glorifies the hard work of common workers?
 b) How does the poem Bharat Our Land reflect a strong connection to cultural identity and heritage?

- Q11. Answer ANY ONE question in 100-120 words (5x1=5 Marks)
 a) The chapter 'Pot Maker' highlights how passion at times, overpowers the sense of practicality as presented by Sentila and her mother Arena. Elaborate.
 b) How did Pankha develop through history to its present shape and variety?